

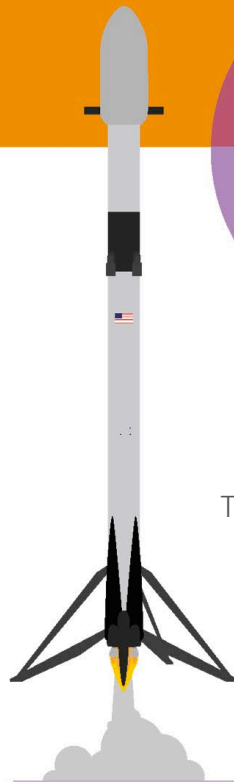
March

30

2017

Reusable rocket

The SpaceX booster launched from Cape Canaveral, USA, marking the first successful flight of a reused rocket. The same booster had flown into space the previous year.



1842

First anaesthetic

US doctor Crawford Long gave ether to his patient James Venable while removing his neck tumour. This was the first-ever use of an anaesthetic for pain relief during an operation.



Born this day

1908 Devika Rani, Indian film star. She played lead roles in films about women's issues and ran her own production company.

World cruise

Ocean liner RMS *Laconia* sailed back into New York Harbor, USA, as the first passenger cruise ship to circle the world. With 400 passengers, RMS *Laconia* had visited 22 ports in 130 days.

1923

Also on this day

239 BCE Halley's Comet was observed for the first time by Chinese astronomers. The comet passes by Earth every 76 years or so.

1861 British chemist William Crookes announced his discovery of the element thallium.

1987 US actor Marlee Matlin became the first Deaf performer to win an Oscar for Best Actress, in *Children of a Lesser God*.

